



Battery, telecom, automobile, PV included in new PLI scheme

The union cabinet chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi has approved the introduction of Production-Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme in ten key sectors to enhance India's manufacturing capabilities and exports for an Atmanirbhar Bharat. A total of ₹1,459.8 billion has been approved for a financial outlay spread over five years. The new PLI scheme mentions a semiconductor as well as a display fab.

"The PLI scheme across these 10 key specific sectors will make Indian manufacturers globally competitive, attract investment in the areas of core competency and cutting-edge technology; ensure efficiencies; create economies of scale; enhance exports and make India an integral part of the global supply chain," read an official press note released by the govern-

ment of India. It continued, "India is expected to have a USD 1 trillion digital economy by 2025. Additionally, the Government's push for data localisation, Internet of Things market in India, projects such as Smart City and Digital India are expected to increase the demand for electronic products. The PLI scheme will boost the production of electronic products in India."

₹50 billion for the electronic/technology products vertical, ₹181 billion for the advanced chemistry cell battery, ₹570.42 billion for the automobile and auto components PLI scheme, ₹121.95 billion for the telecom equipment, ₹45 billion for the solar PVs, and ₹62.38 billion for the white goods have been earmarked in the new PLI scheme.

Construction drone market to reach \$11.96 billion by 2027

The global construction drone industry garnered \$4.80 billion in 2019. As per Allied Market Research, it is projected to reach \$11.96 billion by 2027 at a CAGR of 15.4 per cent. The infrastructure inspection segment is expected to witness the highest CAGR of 17.1 per cent, owing to features of drones such as cost effectiveness, high range, accuracy, and excellent endurance.

By type, the rotary-wing drones segment accounted for more than four-fifths of the total share of the global construction drone market in 2019, and is estimated to continue its lead

position throughout the forecast period. Based on application, the land surveying segment held the highest market share, accounting for nearly half of the global construction drone market in 2019, and is estimated to continue its dominance throughout the forecast period.

Indo-Pacific, followed by North America, accounted for the highest market share in 2019. This region is expected to witness the largest CAGR of 17.8 per cent during the forecast period due to the rise in urbanisation and surge in construction activities in countries including China and India.

ON THE move

Panasonic appoints veteran Yuki Kusumi as CEO

Japan's Panasonic Corp has appointed its head of automotive business Yuki Kusumi as next CEO, replacing Kazuhiro Tsuga, who was the architect of a partnership with Tesla Inc. He will take over on April 1, 2021, after a three-decade career at the company, which saw Kusumi lead the automotive component business and the TV operations. Kusumi also oversaw the launch of a joint battery venture with Toyota Motor Corp in April. Panasonic has shifted its focus away from low-margin consumer electronics to batteries, factory machines, and components.

PVG Menon appointed as CEO of ESSCI

Electronics Skill Sector Council of India (ESSCI) has appointed PVG Menon as its CEO. Menon started his career as a multimedia specialist with CMC limited in 1988. He moved to Siemens Information Systems in 1993. Menon also worked with Analog Devices as a product line manager for over five years. Prior to founding VANN Consulting, he was serving as a senior business development manager with NXP Semiconductors. Menon has served as the president of the India Electronics and Semiconductor Association from August 2011 to March 2014.

Sanjeev Keskar starts a consulting firm

Sanjeev Keskar has quit Arrow Electronics India to start a consulting firm named Arvind Consultancy. Named after his late father, the consulting firm is focusing on developing a high-value-added ecosystem for electronics in the country. The consultancy will support startups in IP creation and manufacturing companies on value addition. Sanjeev has experience in different aspects of the electronics industry spanning from design to pricing a product, circuit design ecology, kits and chipsets pricing, and the semiconductor industry.

Acharya to lead EESL subsidiary

Energy Efficiency Services Limited (EESL) has appointed Mahua Acharya to lead a new 100% owned subsidiary of EESL – Convergence Energy Services Limited. It focuses on energy solutions that lie at the confluence of renewable energy, electric mobility, and climate change. Acharya has almost two decades of international experience in green finance, renewables, and carbon markets. She was the assistant director-general of Global Green Growth Institute, an intergovernmental organisation headquartered in Seoul.